

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

UK: Europe at crossroads in history

British PM Starmer urges leaders to step up support of Ukraine

By Brian Melley and Emma Burrows
Associated Press

LONDON — British Prime Minister Keir Starmer rallied his European counterparts Sunday to shore up their borders and throw

their full weight behind Ukraine as he announced outlines of a plan to end Russia's war.

"Every nation must contribute to that in the best way that it can, bringing different capabilities and support to the table, but all taking responsibility to act, all stepping up their own share of the burden," he said.

Starmer's exhortation to 18 fellow leaders that they need to do the heavy lifting for their own

security comes two days after U.S. backing of Ukraine appeared in jeopardy when President Donald Trump lashed out at Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and said Zelenskyy wasn't grateful enough for America's support.

The meeting had been overshadowed by the extraordinary scolding that took place on live television at the White House.

Starmer used the opportunity as part of his broader effort to bridge

the gap between Europe and the U.S. and also salvage what had seemed like the start of a peace process before Friday's spat.

Starmer said he had worked with France and Ukraine on a plan to end the war and that the group of leaders — mostly from Europe — had agreed on four things.

The steps toward peace would: keep aid flowing to Kyiv and maintain economic pressure on Russia to strengthen Ukraine's

hand; make sure Ukraine is at the bargaining table and any peace deal must ensure its sovereignty and security; and continue to arm Ukraine to deter future invasion.

Finally, Starmer said they would develop a "coalition of the willing" to defend Ukraine and guarantee the peace.

"Not every nation will feel able to contribute but that can't mean

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Departing COPA chief looks back on tenure

Kersten says oversight of police is in better shape than 4 years ago

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

Four years ago, 20 members of the Chicago City Council signed a letter to then-Mayor Lori Lightfoot, "vehemently" opposing her nominee to lead the Civilian Office of Police Accountability, Andrea Kersten, who was the agency's deputy chief administrator at the time.

COPA, bound by the city's municipal code, had recently released its report on the Chicago Police Department's botched raid at the home of Anjanette Young in 2019. In that report, authored by Kersten, the agency recommended a three-day suspension for police Officer Ella French because she didn't have a body-worn camera.

French was killed in an on-duty shooting after the raid but before the report's public release. Kersten publicly apologized for not redacting French's name from the report, and she spoke privately with the slain officer's family.

But the pro-police wing of the City Council wanted its pound of flesh, and that group of 20 aldermen — two of whom were later convicted of federal crimes — held firm in its opposition. Still, the full council confirmed Kersten as

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HIGHLAND PARK SHOOTING TRIAL

Defense attorneys weigh in on impartiality

Opening statements to begin as jurors prepare to hear case

By Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

The night before one man was selected to the jury for the Highland Park parade shooting trial, he briefly discussed the case at home with his wife, he said.

"I could see in her face that she was, I guess, disgusted," the warehouse employee told a defense lawyer during the jury selection process last week. "Disgusted was the look she had on her face."

It was the second day of jury selection in the trial of Robert Crimo III, who is accused of carrying out the 2022 Independence Day mass shooting, which left seven people dead, four dozen injured and an entire community traumatized.

Crimo's public defender then asked the man — a nearly decade-long resident of Lake County who said that for the most part he "very barely" remembers the shooting — if he could set aside those emotions

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Braxton Farr, 24, jumps up and down with happiness with the arrival of caregiver Kareem Stevenson on Feb. 10 in Elmhurst. **STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE**

Battling state's 'barriers' to community placement

In Chicago and beyond, people with developmental disabilities can wait years

By Olivia Olander and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

Aaron Bass likes some things about Shapiro Developmental Center, a home he shares with some 500 others on a site along the Kankakee River that first housed Illinois residents with disabilities nearly 150 years ago.

He enjoys spending time outdoors, playing bingo and supervised outings to Burger

King, the dollar store or local library to check out scary movies. But Bass, a 39-year-old who has a moderate intellectual disability, said he is seeking something greater.

"I want to see what it looks like ... freedom," he said in an interview at the Kankakee Public Library, about a mile from the sprawling Shapiro campus.

Bass is one of hundreds of people living in state-operated developmental centers who have

requested a move, typically to smaller group homes in community settings that offer greater independence.

While advocates credit Gov. JB Pritzker with putting a higher level of attention on the issue, the fights for placement in many cases underscore the state's ongoing struggle to provide options for people with complex needs.

In January, a watchdog group found there were "concerning barriers" for people trying

to transfer out of Choate Developmental Center in downstate Anna, almost two years after the Pritzker administration initiated plans to move out roughly half of Choate's residents following years of reported resident abuse that led to more than a dozen criminal charges against employees.

But Choate isn't the only state-operated developmental center that some residents are

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Michigan Avenue rally backs Ukraine

Activists and members of Chicago's Ukrainian American community march along North Michigan Avenue on Sunday in support of Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy after his heated exchange with President Donald Trump on Friday over how to end the war between Ukraine and Russia. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Culkin given first award at Oscars

Kieran Culkin earned the Oscar for best supporting actor at the Academy Awards, completing a sweep of the category for his performance in "A Real Pain." **Arts & Living**

Israel halts supply of aid into Gaza

Israel faced sharp criticism as it stopped the entry of all food and other supplies into Gaza on Sunday and warned of "additional consequences" for Hamas if a fragile ceasefire wasn't extended. **Nation & World**

Notre Dame women reach turning point

No. 3 Irish win last regular season game, but after two losses in the final week of the regular season, are they still considered favorites in NCAA? **Chicago Sports**

